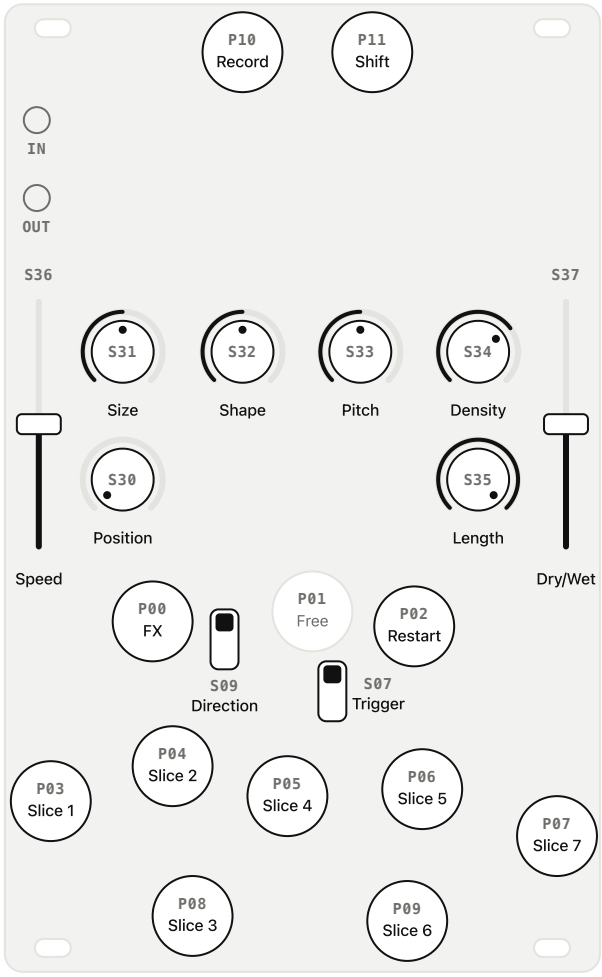
Simple Touch

# Clessidra

It's the instrument where you pour grains of sound from single drops into a dense cloud.

francescodimaggio.nl/clessidra

Synthux Design Residency 2026




Three layers: own, P11 (Shift) held for each knob's randomness, P00 held for FX.

Pick-up: a knob takes over a value once it reaches it.

Randomness: off at the centre, up even, down a long tail.

## LAYERS

| CONTROL | OWN | P11 SHIFT | P00 FX |
|---|---|---|---|
| S36 | Speed | – | – |
| S37 | Dry/Wet | – | – |
| S30 | Position | Position Random | – |
| S35 | Length | Length Random | – |
| S31 | Size | Size Random | Filter |
| S32 | Shape | Shape Random | Reverb |
| S33 | Pitch | Pitch Random | – |
| S34 | Density | Density Random | – |

## FADERS AND KNOBS

| | |
|---|---|
| S36 | Playhead speed, 0 to 4×. 1× at the centre, stopped at the bottom. |
| S37 | Input and grains, equal power. 0 % dry, 100 % wet. |
| S30 | Selection start, anywhere in the recording. |
| P11 + S30 | Position randomness per grain. Off at the centre, up even, down a long tail. |
| S35 | Selection length, past the end round to the start. All at the top. |
| P11 + S35 | Length randomness per pass. Off at the centre, up even, down a long tail. |
| S31 | Grain size, 10 ms to 4 s. 200 ms at the centre. At most half the recording. |
| P11 + S31 | Size randomness per grain. Off at the centre, up even, down a long tail. |
| P00 + S31 | Low-pass left, 20 kHz to 200 Hz. Off at the centre. High-pass right, to 2 kHz. |
| S32 | Grain window: reverse percussive, Hann at the centre, percussive. |
| P11 + S32 | Shape randomness per grain. Off at the centre, up even, down a long tail. |
| P00 + S32 | Reverb on the grains. Amount and decay, 0.5 to 16 s. |
| S33 | ±24 semitones. Stops at 0, 0.1, 5, 7, 12, 17, 19, 24. |
| P11 + S33 | Pitch randomness per grain. Off at the centre, up even, down a long tail. |
| S34 | Grains per second. None at the bottom, then 0.3 to 131, exponential. |
| P11 + S34 | Density randomness of the starts. Off at the centre, up even, down a long tail. |

## PADS AND SWITCHES

| | |
|---|---|
| P10 | Tap: the last 8 s. Hold: until release, up to 30 s. |
| P11 | Held: the knobs set their randomness. |
| P00 | Held: S31 filter, S32 reverb. Over Shift. |
| P02 | Playhead to the selection start. |
| P03–P09 | Plays its slice with its own grains, as Trigger sets. Pressure sets density. |
| S09 | Up forward, centre freeze, down reverse. Playhead and slices. |
| S07 | Slice pads: up once to the end, centre while held, down looped while held. |

## LED

| | |
|---|---|
| Glow | Grains playing |
| Flashing | Recording |
| Pulse | At a centre: pitch unison, speed 1×, size 200 ms |
| Steady | P11 or P00 held: the value of the knob last turned |